INCH-POUND

A-A-20165B
February 12, 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20165A
February 14, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

POTATO-BASED MIX, PELLETIZED, DEHYDRATED (FOR FRENCH-FRIED TYPE PRODUCTS)

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix, for use with extruder equipment with an internal rehydrating device, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, and local governments and other interested parties.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 Raw ingredients: The dehydrated potato pellets shall be prepared from clean, sound, white fleshed whole or potato pieces which are dehydrated in accordance with good manufacturing practices.

2.1.1 Additives and ingredients: The dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall contain those additives appropriate for manufacturing. All additives or ingredients used in the preparation of the product shall be of Food Chemicals Codex purity.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, Defense Supply Center Philadelphia, 2800 South 20th Street, ATTN: DSCP-HSL, Philadelphia, PA 19145-5099 or FAX (215) 737-2963.

AMSC N/A **FSC 8915**

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2.2 DEHYDRATED PRODUCT:

2.2.1 Defects: There shall not be any specific defect or combination of defects which materially affects the appearance, edibility, storage, or shipping quality of the dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix.

2.2.2 Composition: The French-fried potato mix shall be composed of dehydrated potato pellets, starch, guar gum, salt, hydroxypropyl methycellulose, natural and artificial flavors, sodium bisulfite, butylated hydroxyanisole, and/or butylated hydroxytoluene.

2.2.3 Potato mix shape: The dehydrated potato-based mix shall be in a porous pelletized form, free flowing, and free from clumps that will not break under slight finger pressure. The finished product pelletization shall be of such size that a minimum of 80 percent, by weight, shall be retained on a U.S. Standard No. 6 sieve and a maximum of 10 percent, by weight, shall be retained on a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve.

2.2.4 Moisture: The dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall contain not more than 7.0 percent moisture.

2.2.5 Sulfite content: The dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall have a sulfite content of 200-500 ppm. 1/ 2/

1/ Calculated as sulfur dioxide. ppm = parts per million
2/ Sulfite levels shall not exceed the maximum levels established under the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

2.2.6 Labeling: Directions on the package shall include the following:

FOR USE IN POTATO EXTRUDER EQUIPMENT WITH INTERNAL REHYDRATING DEVICE. OPEN CAN/BAG, POUR INTO HOPPER.

2.3 REHYDRATED PRODUCT:

2.3.1 Product performance: The product shall completely rehydrate in the internal rehydration chamber of the dispensing machine in less than 60 seconds. (See 2.7.6.)

2.3.2 Color: When extruded and fried in accordance with label directions, the prepared French-fried potato colors shall be determined by using USDA color standards for frozen french-fried potatoes. The French-fried potatoes shall meet color standards not lighter than USDA No. 0 nor darker than USDA No. 2 color standard for frozen french-fried potatoes and shall be practically free from variable colors.

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2.3.3 Texture: When extruded and fried in accordance with label directions, the French-fried potatoes shall have a texture typical of Grade A French-fried potatoes.

2.3.4 Fat content: When extruded and fried in accordance with label directions, the fat content for the prepared French-fried potatoes shall be not less than 15.0 percent and shall not exceed 22.0 percent by weight of the finished product. (See 2.7.7)

2.3.5 Odor and flavor: When extruded and fried in accordance with label directions, the French-fried potatoes shall have a flavor typical of fresh cooked French-fried potatoes and shall be free from objectionable odors and flavors.

2.4 Foreign material: The dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from evidence of rodent or insect infestation. There shall be practically no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

2.5 Age requirement: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall be produced /packaged no more than 120 days prior to date of delivery.

2.6 Shelf life: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall have a shelf life of at least 12 months from date of production/packaging.

2.7 Analytical requirements: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall be as stated in paragraphs 2.2.4, 2.2.5, and 2.3.4.

2.7.1 Analytical procedure: Three containers shall be selected at random.

2.7.2 Preparation of sample: The sample to be analyzed shall be a one-pound composite sample derived from a composite of the three randomly selected containers. Prepare a clean, dry Waring Blendor or similar mill by grinding a sample and then discarding it. Grind approximately 100 grams of the well-mixed sample in the prepared Waring Blendor or similar mill for one minute. Place the ground material in a small, dry, tightly-closed container for at least ½ hour. Pass the ground material over a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve nested on a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve. That portion which passes through the 20 mesh screen but not the 40 mesh screen is to be analyzed and shall be weighed immediately or placed in a small, dry container with a tightly closed lid until ready for analysis (a one-half pint Mason jar is satisfactory).

2.7.3 Analytical testing: The sample shall be analyzed using the following Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International methods as follows:

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Test	Method
Moisture 1/ (loss on drying)	934.06
Sulfite	962.16
Fat	933.05

1/ Place the sample dishes with cocked lids in the vacuum-oven and dry for 6 hours at 70°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm of mercury.

2.7.4 Test results: The test results for moisture and fat shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Test results for sulfite content shall be reported to the nearest 10 ppm. The pellet size shall be reported to the nearest 1 percent. Any result not conforming to the finished product requirements shall be cause for rejection the lot.

2.7.5 Pellet size: The pellet size of the dehydrated potato-based mix shall be determined by sieve testing. The contents of one primary container, approximately 100 g ± 0.1 g at a time, shall be mechanically shaken (Rotap, W.S. Tyler, or equivalent) for 30 seconds without tap on a U.S. Standard No. 6 sieve nested over a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve.

2.7.5.1 Screening procedure: Open a can of dehydrated potato-based mix and pour it through a splitter, or open a bag and remove approximately one pound (454 g) of product. Weigh out a 100 g ± 0.1 g sample on a paper plate. Assemble sieves in the following order from top to bottom: U.S. Standard No. 6 sieve, U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve, three blank sieves larger than a U.S. Standard No. 6 sieve, and a pan. Pour the weighed sample onto the top sieve. Place the nested sieves in a Rotap, W.S. Tyler, or equivalent, and shake for only 30 seconds with the tapper raised. Remove the sieves from the Rotap, W.S. Tyler, or equivalent, separate and weigh the product on the U.S. Standard No. 6 and U.S. Standard No. 8 sieves and in the pan.

2.7.6 Testing in dispenser equipment with internal rehydrating device: Follow Series 500 dispenser machine operating, cleaning, and charging instructions. Open a can or bag of potato mix product, pour the contents into the dispenser machine hopper. Follow the dispenser machine operating instructions and charge the dispenser. When the potato mix is fully rehydrated, the ready light on the front of dispenser will illuminate. The dispenser is ready to operate. Depress the ready button, the dispenser machine will automatically dispense a 22 ounce (624 g) portion for sampling. Collect the formed product on a transfer tray. The dispensed potato mix product pieces or shapes should be uniformly formed. Dispensed product should not be soupy or contain large dry pockets of unrehydrated potato mix. Small specks of unrehydrated potato uniformly dispersed in the formed product is normal.

2.7.7 Fry test: Dispense another 22 ounce (624 g) portion for sampling onto a transfer tray. Submerge the fry basket into good quality clean frying oil heated to 350°F (176.6°C). Shake the

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dispensed product in the submerged fry basket. Wait 10 seconds, raise the fry basket and lightly shake the product three times. Resubmerge the basket and continue cooking for 80 seconds or to desired color.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 The delivered dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix within the commercial marketplace. Delivered dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Product conformance. The dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The dehydrated pelletized potato-based mix shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

5. PACKAGING.

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

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6. NOTES.

6.1 Sources of documents.

6.1.1 Sources of information for nongovernmental document are as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

Copies of the Food Chemicals Codex may be purchased from: **National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, NW, Washington, DC 20418.**

6.1.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Information concerning licensed suppliers of USDA color standards for frozen french-fried potatoes may be obtained from: **Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0247, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0247.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DLA - SS

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